on water conservation and restoration, DS Group has ongoing Water Conservation projects in 6 states of India, namely Rajasthan, Madhya Pradesh, Uttar Pradesh, Himachal Pradesh, Uttarakhand, and Gujarat.

Therefore the construction of recharging and storage structures, renovation of existing defunct and underutilized water bodies, and soil conservation measures are taken on under this project. The Group is also forming and nurturing two-tier community institutions, water user groups for regulating water utilization at the source level, and the village development committees.

The Group conceptualized the 'Water Economic Zone, an integrated watershed development project in 2018 to enhance natural resources, particularly water and soil for supporting an agriculture-based economy. Through this project alone, the DS Group's CSR programme has reached out to more than 23000 people from 26 villages, mostly from the tribal background. The project has treated an area of around 11000 hectares in Alsigarh and Kurabad areas of Udaipur.

Prior to the intervention, the area was characterized by low productivity, rain-fed farming, severe soil erosion and degraded land and forest. Alternative practices like drip irrigation, rain guns based on Solar Pumps, which reduces the practice of flood irrigation and use of fossil fuel based-pumps focus on water preservation and usage of green energy. Besides this, the Farmers were trained on Good Agricultural Practices (GAP) for existing crops.

This project is now being replicated in 3000 ha. Area in Khandwa and 1700 ha area in Betul districts of Madhya Pradesh.

Under the water conservation initiatives, 900+ water harvesting structures have been constructed or renovated with a cumulative storage capacity of around 80 Lakh cubic metres till date, bringing more than 2300 hectare area under irrigation.

Livelihood Enhancement

The Group supports a range of projects, which are focused on strengthening the enabling environment for existing livelihood opportunities by providing backward and forward linkages, inculcating improved practices, value addition in products, introducing new technology, facilitating environment and imparting skills for sustainably enhancing incomes. The associated community is also endowed with market-oriented skills and vision to explore diverse avenues to utilize the opportunities in the emerging job market.

Agriculture, Livestock, Entrepreneurship and Skill Development have been the core sub-thematic areas of Intervention. In agriculture, Sustainable and Comprehensive Agriculture for Livelihood Enhancement (SCALE) is a one of its' kind project where farmers are being provided with end-to-end support to encourage large-scale production so that they can directly supply to institutional buyers. The Group is also supporting Farmer Producer Organisation (FPO) for these projects.

The CSR interventions of the DS Group have already impacted livelihoods of 29,263 households across Rajasthan, Madhya Pradesh, Uttar Pradesh, Jharkhand, Maharashtra, Assam, and Tripura. The Group directly works with more than 25,000 Farmers on improved agricultural practices, diversified crop patterns, organic farming, post-harvesting practices, market linkages, and livestock management. As of today, approximately 250 households have been supported by the Group through acclaimed Civil Society Organisations (CSO), working in this sub-thematic area.

Education

Initiated in the year 2015, the Group has undertaken a wide range of initiatives to promote quality education through Formal, Non-formal & Remedial methods. The projects are largely focused on bringing development in cognitive and affected domains of the children. The group is running - schools to provide formal education to underserved communities and supporting a school in the tribal area of Sheopur district in Madhya Pradesh. For Non-formal and Remedial education the group has partnered with CSOs that expose students to methodology. Through these projects, the group has served more than 20,000 tribal and urban slum-dwelling students in the age groups 3 to 22 years.

Apart from this, through a very unique project called "Creative Adda", the group also encourages skill based education for the students. The students are facilitated to explore their learning interests and co-create and design their own learning path.

Other Interventions

The Group also actively undertakes various other CSR interventions which contribute towards the Sustainable Development Goals (SDG). These interventions include setting up mid-day meal kitchens, promoting Swachh Bharat Abhiyan by constructing toilets & spreading awareness, providing basic medical services, renovating schools, supporting orphans, setting up mobile medical units, disaster relief works etc.







